



## PROGRESS REPORT

# Digital Identity and CRVS: progress report, 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-01

Edition of 2026-09-01 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

3 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

AFRICA · SOUTHERN AFRICA · WEST AFRICA

**Movement values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

## Africa

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                                                                         | AT 2025-09-01                | AT 2026-09-01                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| ADLI cohort on the AfCFTA Digital Identity Annex                                                   | Did not exist                | Six countries across three trade corridors working on compliance with the annex, on a test-and-learn basis; no assessment or mutual-recognition decision held                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | ADVANCED          |
| Adults holding official identification in Sub-Saharan Africa                                       | None published on this basis | 81% of adults, 82% of men against 79% of women, a 3.56-point gender gap (2025)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | BASELINE NOT HELD |
| APAI-CRVS (Africa Programme on Accelerated Improvement of Civil Registration and Vital Statistics) | BASELINE NOT HELD            | The 2017-2026 decade is closing and a 2027-2036 phase is opening; the African eCRVS Shared Asset (ACSA) is named as the shared continental standard intended to cut fragmented digital procurement across country systems, and Equatorial Guinea's Justice Ministry timed a free registration campaign for children aged 0-5 (10-14 August 2026) to the decade's close. No AU statement of the new phase's content, financing or targets is held | Baseline not held |
| Continental ID and data-protection law analyser                                                    | Baseline not held            | An open-source tool launched by a university research network comparing identity and data-protection laws across more than 50 African countries, built as a retrieval-augmented chatbot and stated as intended to help states harmonise their frameworks; no usage figure, governance arrangement or maintenance commitment is published                                                                                                         | BASELINE NOT HELD |
| Smart Africa digital identity blueprint                                                            | BASELINE NOT HELD            | The alliance secretariat's first-edition blueprint for mutually recognised digital identity across member states, setting out the trust alliance, levels of assurance and the case for interoperable identity, drawn up after a member-state workshop                                                                                                                                                                                            | Baseline not held |

## Southern Africa

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                             | AT 2025-09-01                                                    | AT 2026-09-01                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>SADC cross-border digital-ID and eKYC framework</b> | A South Africa-Lesotho verification pilot, no regional framework | Federated framework announced for all 16 member states; no build, budget or launch date on record in the year since | ADVANCED |

## West Africa

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                                                             | AT 2025-09-01                                                                                  | AT 2026-09-01                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>AES biometric passport</b>                                                          | Launched in January 2025, with no state-by-state issuance on record                            | Issuing in all three states, with Mali's supplied by China's Emptech in place of France's Idemia                                                                                                          | ADVANCED |
| <b>CIB-AES (AES biometric identity card)</b>                                           | Did not exist                                                                                  | Issuing in Burkina Faso since December 2025 and in Niger since March 2026, with mass enrolment under way and cross-border enrolment tested in Mali                                                        | ADVANCED |
| <b>ENBIC (ECOWAS National Biometric Identity Card)</b>                                 | Operationalised by six member states, with no rollout held in the largest                      | Rolled out by Nigeria in November 2025 and deployed in the field in Guinea-Bissau under a cross-border traders' project                                                                                   | ADVANCED |
| <b>UEMOA customer identification and verification instruction (003-03-2025)</b>        | Did not exist in this form                                                                     | In force since March 2025: how financial institutions must identify customers, verify identity and know their clientele across the monetary union                                                         | ADVANCED |
| <b>WURI (West Africa Unique Identification for Regional Integration and Inclusion)</b> | Phase 2 running to a closing date of 30 July 2026, with no interoperability strategy validated | A cross-border interoperability and mutual-recognition strategy validated and a 2026 work plan adopted; the phase's stated closing date has passed with no completion, extension or successor record held | ADVANCED |

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EDITION         | <b>2026-09-01</b>                                                                                                                                                             |
| CURRENT EDITION | <a href="https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/dpi-id/dpi-id-progress.html">https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/dpi-id/dpi-id-progress.html</a>                     |
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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.